unfenced military boundary line with troops deployed on either side, into POK. They were welcomed, trained and armed by the Pakistan Army, and then pushed back into the valley to initiate an insurgency. A recent collection of interviews of these insurgents has been published on 10 March 2019 issue of *The Week*.

Zia's Operation Topac

On Gen. Zia-ul-Haq's orders, 'the ISI drew up a plan for Kashmir in 1984 that was to mature in 1991'[4] says Husain Haqqani in *Pakistan: Between Mosque and the Military*. The aim was to run this quasi-military operation in three phases: in phase one, Pakistan was to initiate a low-level insurgency in Kashmir, which it did from late 1989, while still allowing the local government to function so that central rule was not imposed by New Delhi. It would also have Pakistani sympathisers subvert the police forces, financial institutions and other government organisations along with their regular anti-India student and youth-led rioting to prepare Kashmir for secession and a Pakistani-led takeover of the valley. In phase two, as Kashmir remained on the boil, Pakistan would exert military pressure on the Indian Army on the LoC, forcing it to deploy the bulk of its troops along the LoC and in the Siachen region. This was to be followed by attacks on key military cantonments and posts along the LoC to divert the attention of the Indian Army from the turmoil in the valley. Pakistan would then cut off the Kashmir Valley and its airfields, tunnels and highways to prevent an Indian response to any subsequent Pakistani attack. And finally, in phase three, Pakistan would enable the liberation of the Kashmir Valley by creating a mini-Islamic state in the valley. The aim of this was to turn Kashmiris away from their centuries-old culture of Sufism by replacing it with Wahhabi Islam and cleanse the valley of non-Muslims.

Pakistan's generals had put together plans to first challenge the sanctity of the LoC and then to initiate the secession of the valley, in reverse order of their foiled plans of 1965. In the first part, their aim was to capture the Siachen Glacier. As the CFL/LoC ends abruptly at NJ 9842 near Leh, the